

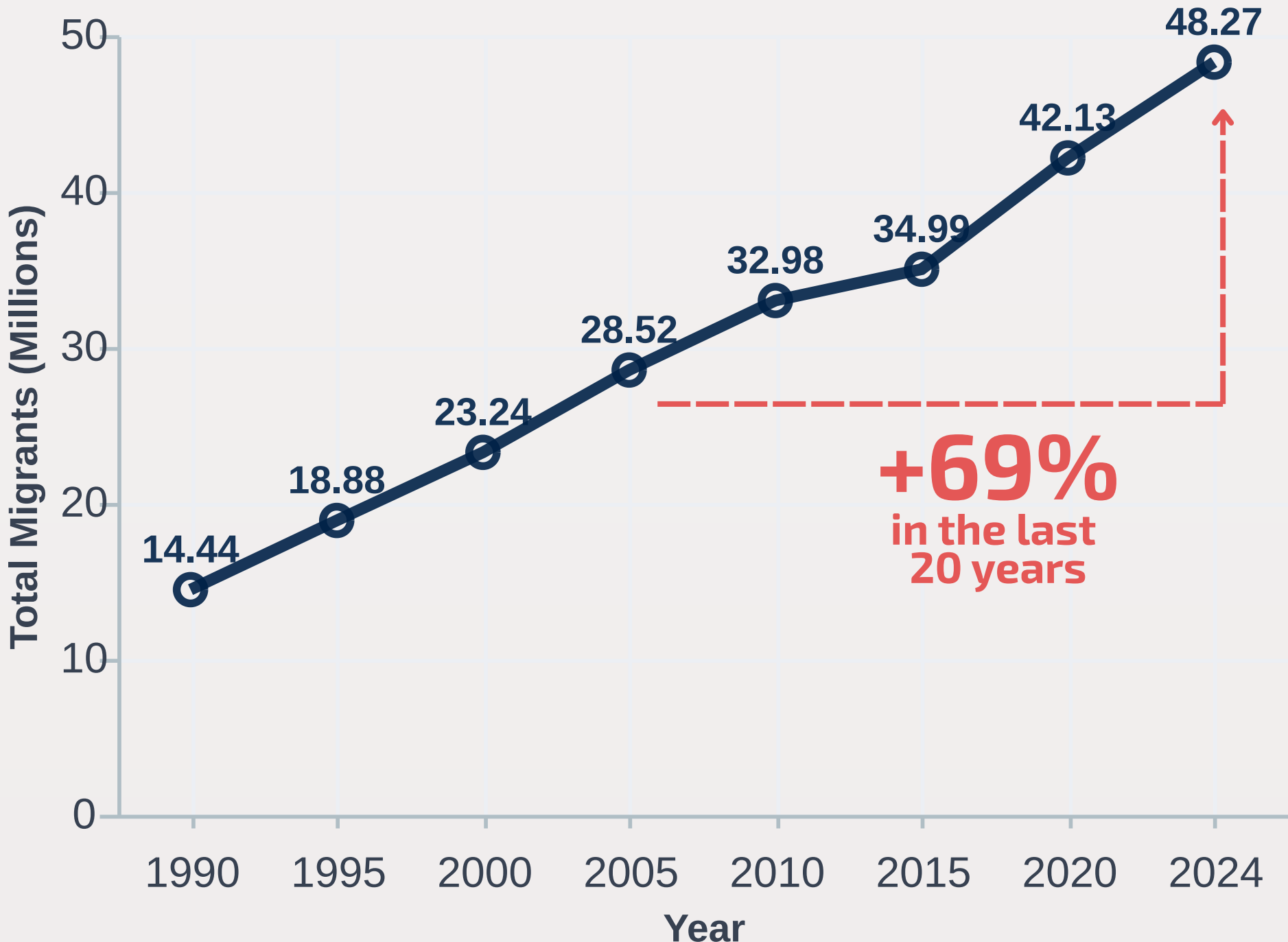
Beyond Borders:

Economic and Social Drivers of Migration in Latin America and the Caribbean

Each year, thousands of people leave their homes in Latin America, the Caribbean and other regions in an effort to secure futures that have become practically unattainable in their countries of origin.

Many will have successfully gone through visa application processes to start a new phase of their lives. Some aren't so lucky, and will be setting off on journeys they know will be long and dangerous, with a risk of failure.

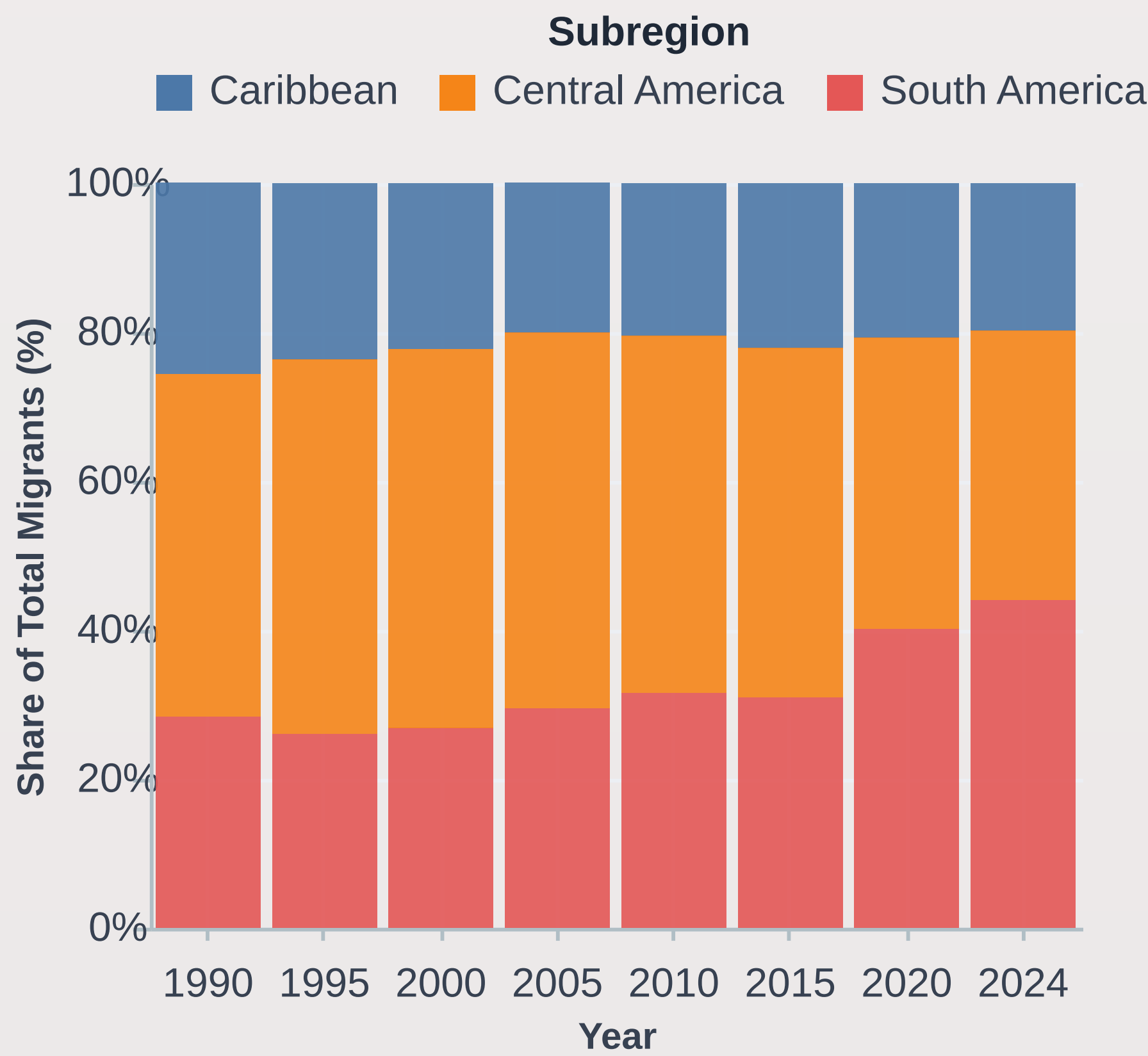
Migration Trend in Latin America and the Caribbean



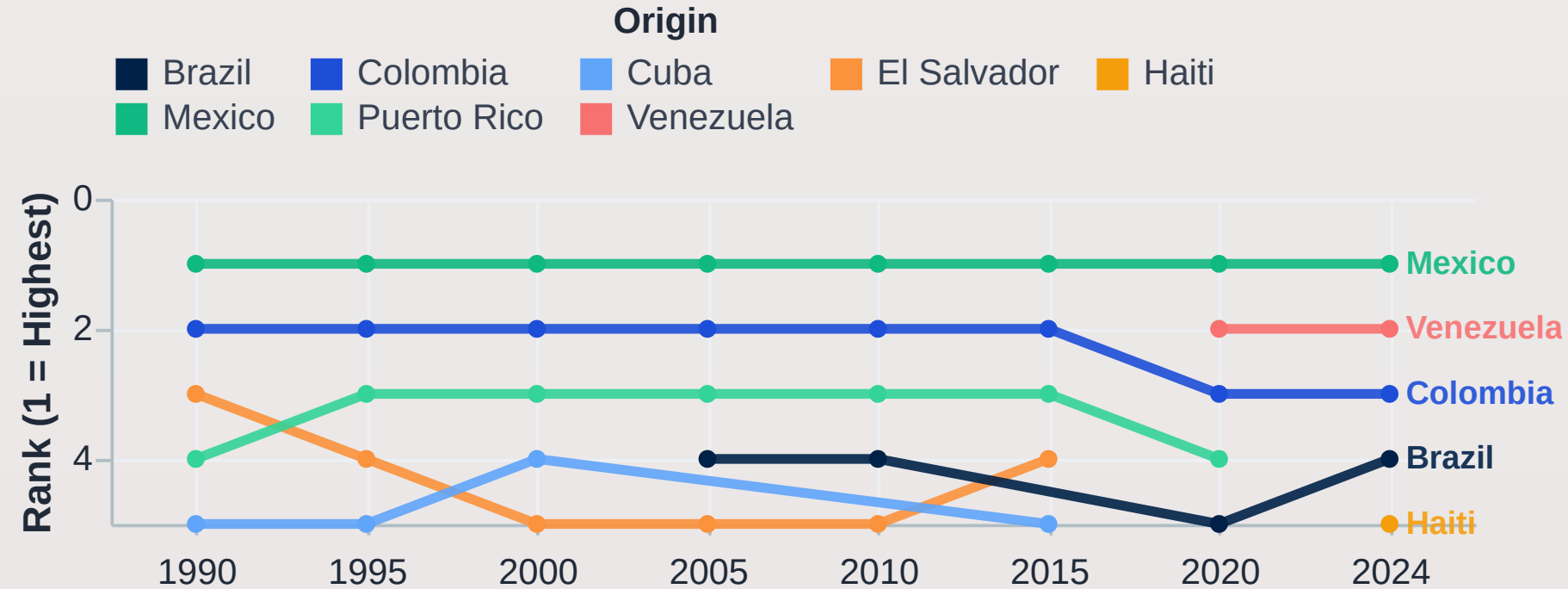
Who is migrating—and where are they going?

Migration in Latin America and the Caribbean is concentrated among a few key countries. Mexico, Colombia, and Venezuela stand out as the main sources of migrants, reflecting both economic pressures and social instability. On the destination side, the United States remains the dominant receiver, followed by regional hubs such as Chile and Argentina, which attract growing numbers of migrants from neighboring nations. This pattern reveals how proximity, shared language, and existing diaspora networks shape migration decisions across the region.

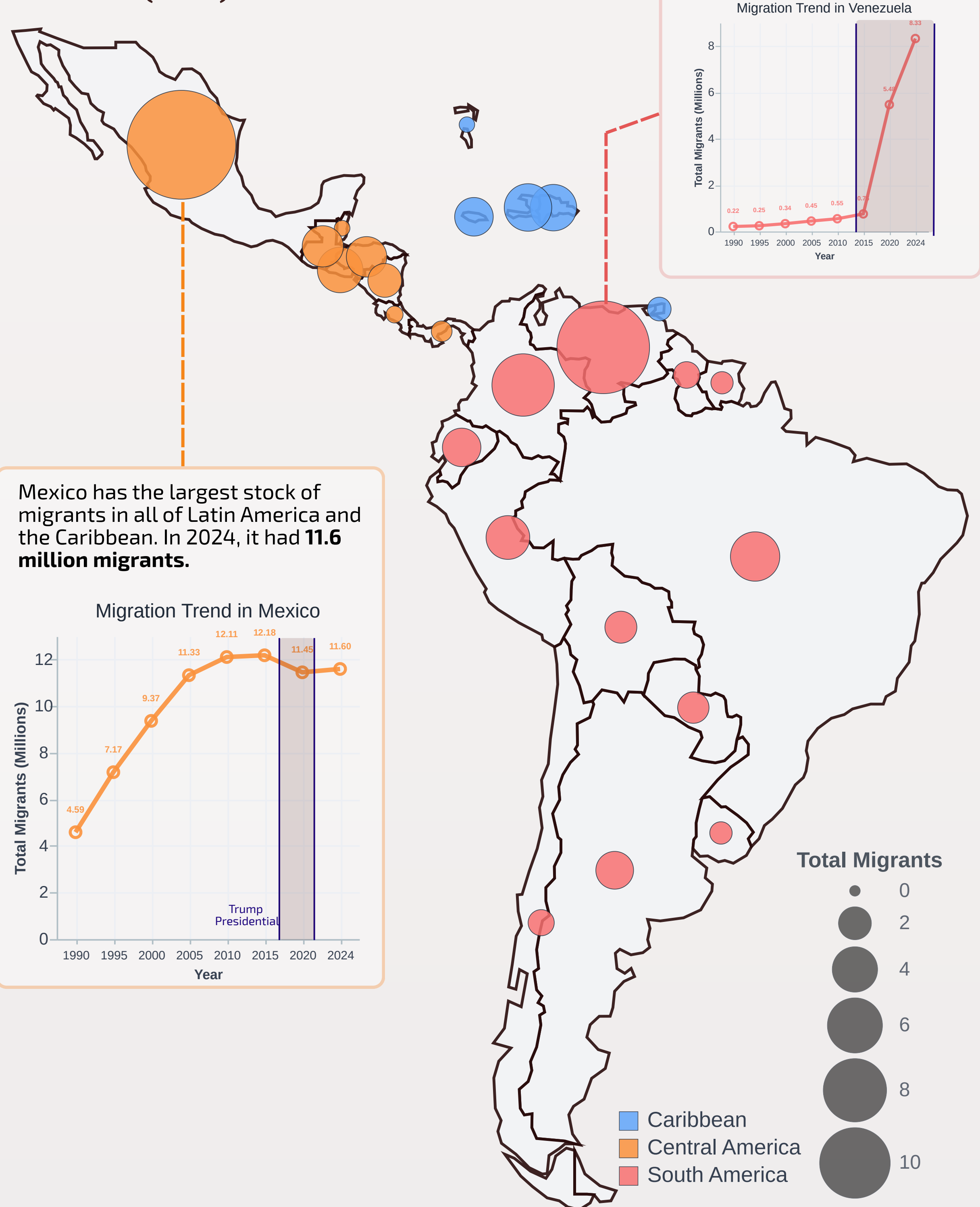
Migration by Sub-Region grouped by sub-region of origin



Top 5 Origin Countries (1990–2024)



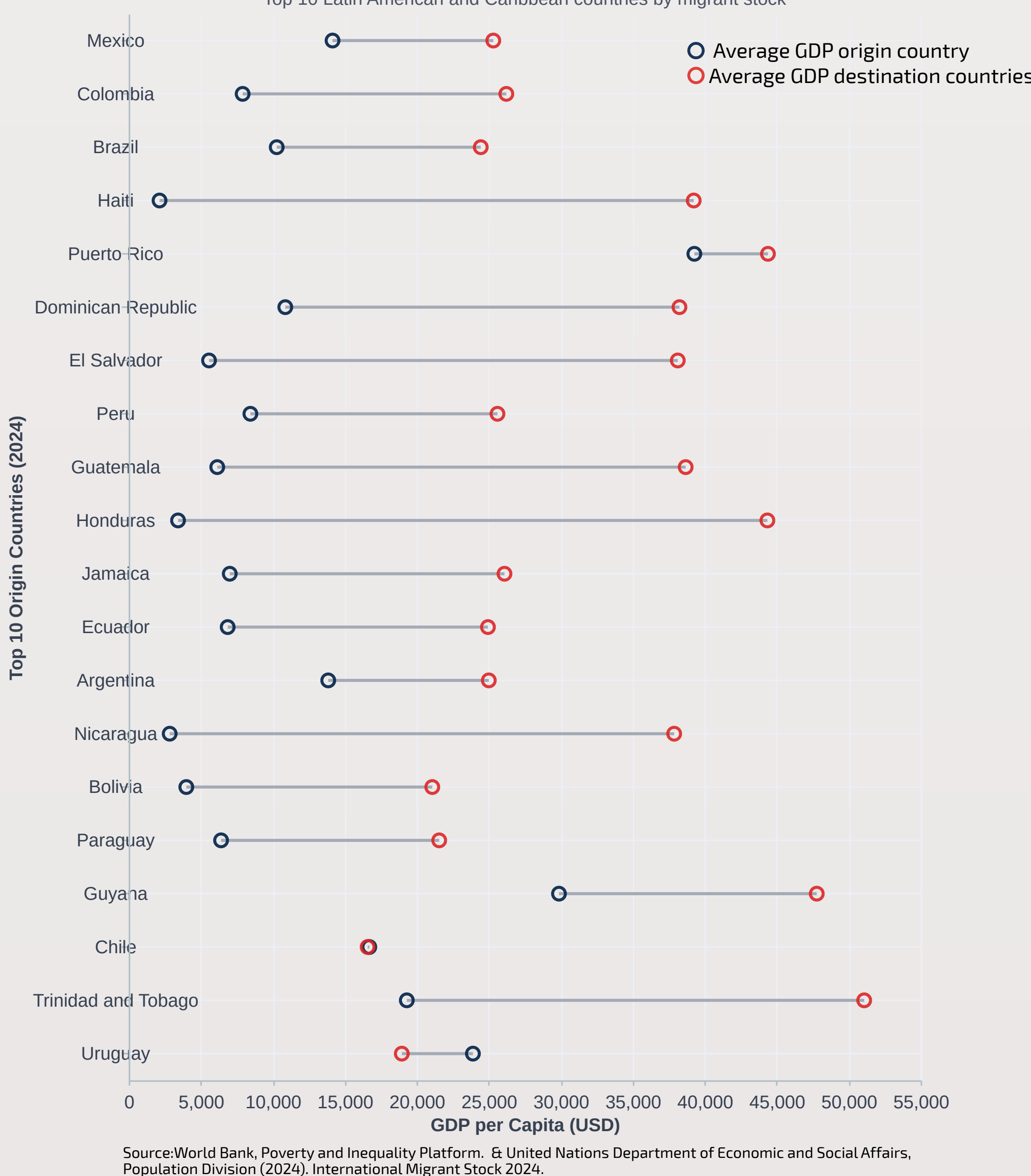
Migration Stock from Latin America and The Caribbean (2024)



So why do people who migrate decide to risk everything, including their own lives?

Although migration is a multidimensional and complex phenomenon, structural factors help explain its persistence across Latin America and the Caribbean. Among them, economic inequality stands out: in 2024, the main countries of origin in the region had a GDP per capita far below that of their destinations. This widening economic gap highlights how unequal access to opportunities continues to shape mobility patterns, driving millions to seek better living conditions abroad.

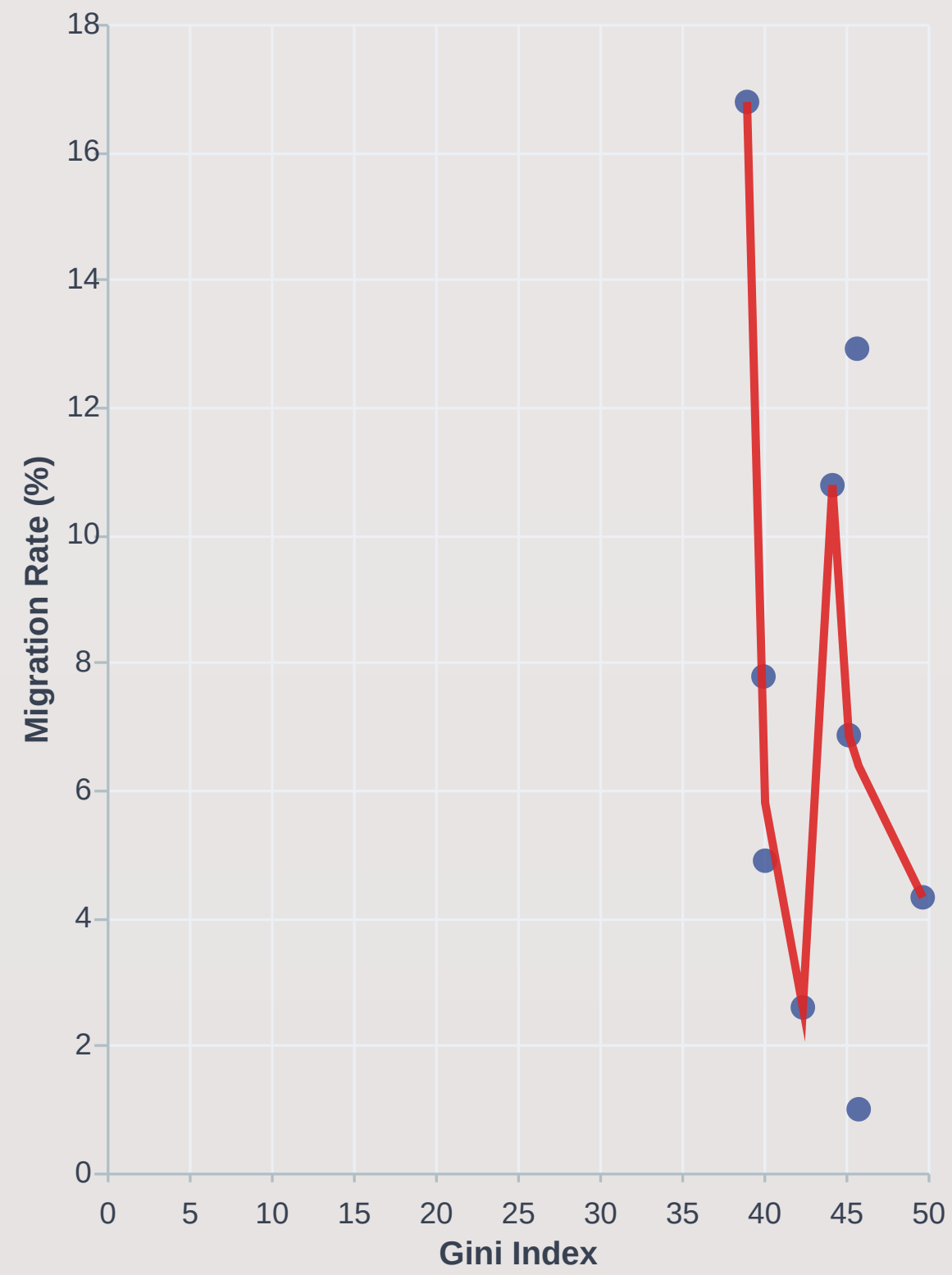
Gap in GDP per Capita between Origin and Destination (2024)



The strcutural Factor

Persistent inequality undermines inclusive growth by concentrating wealth and limiting social mobility. When economic returns to education or labor are disproportionately low for large segments of the population, migration emerges as a rational response to constrained domestic opportunities.

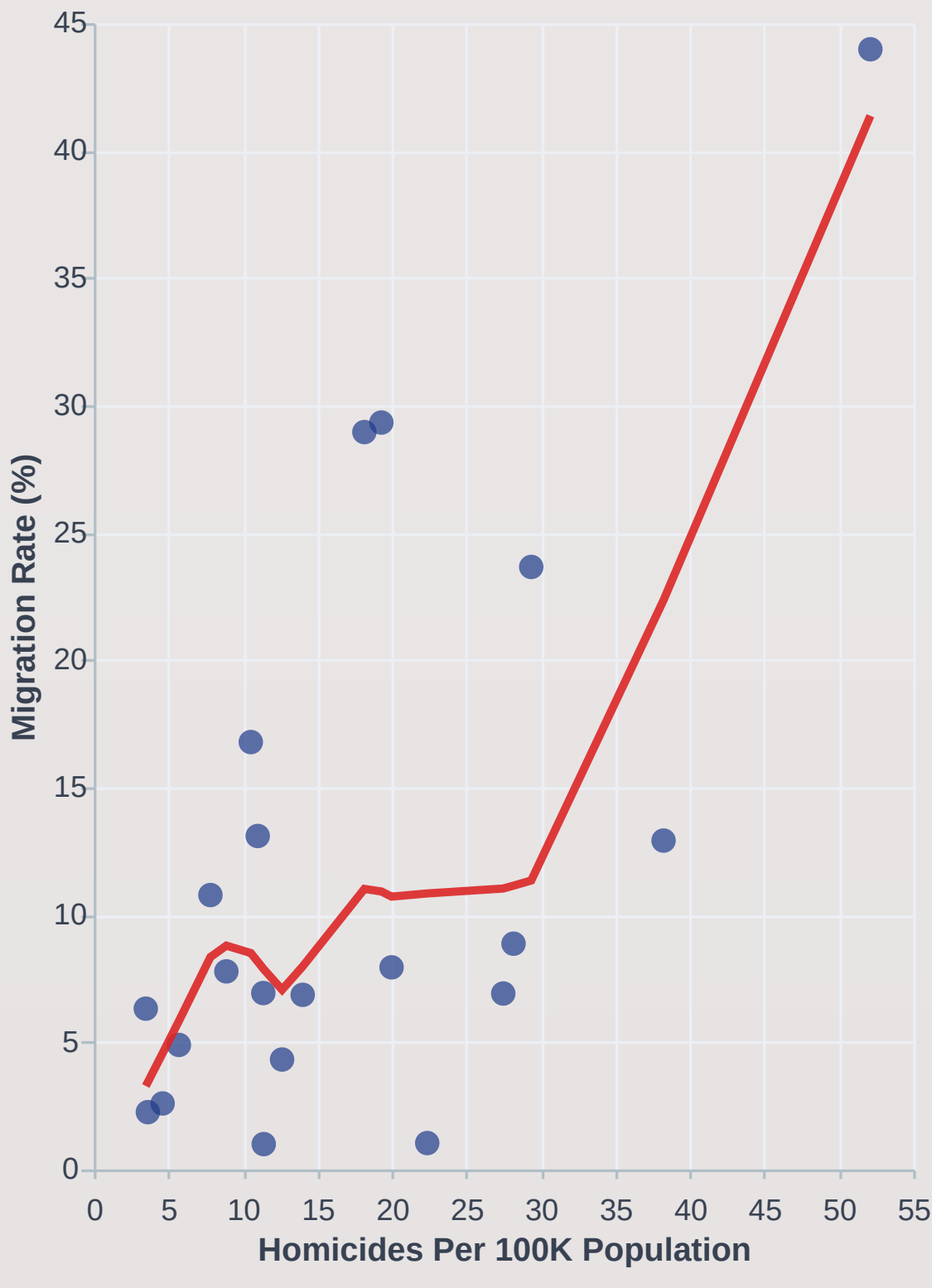
Gini Index vs Migration Rate



Violence and Fear

High levels of violence impose significant economic costs—reducing productivity, deterring investment, and eroding human capital. Under these conditions, migration functions as both a protective mechanism and a means of reallocating labor away from environments of chronic instability.

Homicides Per 100K Population vs Migration Rate



The Climate Trap

Increasing exposure to climate-related shocks weakens agricultural productivity, damages infrastructure, and heightens economic precarity. These environmental risks interact with poverty and limited adaptation capacity, turning climate stress into a powerful driver of migration, particularly in rural and low-income areas.

Climate Risk Index vs Migration Rate

